



Notification Waiver Determination

Blackstone - Dresser Utility Solutions

Acquisition	Endeavour Purchaser V, Inc, an affiliate of various funds advised and/or managed by affiliates of Blackstone Inc. (Blackstone) applied for a notification waiver in respect of its proposed acquisition of 100% of the equity interests in Dresser Utility Solutions, LLC (Dresser), as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	25 August 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, Blackstone, is a US-based corporation, incorporated under the laws of Delaware, United States. Blackstone operates as an investment management firm, not as a conglomerate or holding company. Accordingly, each company in its investment portfolio is independently managed and financed and each has different investors (although the investors in different investment funds may overlap). Each Blackstone portfolio company has its own board of directors, which generally also include Blackstone representatives. The target, Dresser, is a US-based company that manufactures and supplies equipment used globally to build, operate and repair gas and water utility networks. In Australia, Dresser supplies gas meters, gas regulators and couplings & clamp products, both directly and through third-party distributors.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). Based on the information provided in the application, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition. There is no horizontal overlap or vertical relationship between Blackstone or its controlled portfolio companies and Dresser in Australia. In these circumstances, the ACCC does not consider it necessary to reach a concluded view on the likelihood of the notification thresholds being met.

	Given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC's guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
--	---

Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act